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Deputy Director, Data Value

Government Digital Service

Apply before 11:55 pm on Monday 30th November 2026

Government Digital Service

Reference number

489478

Salary

£86,000 - £117,800

£86,000 to £117,800 Based on capability. Non civil servants will be expected to start at the salary minimum if successful. Existing Civil Servants will be appointed in line with the Civil Service pay rules. If you are applying from another Government Department on a lateral move we will match your base salary.

Job grade

SCS Pay Band 1

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

Data Transformation

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

Number of jobs available

1

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Location

Bristol, London, Manchester

About the job

Job summary

Show government what its data is really worth. Then help it decide what to do next.

Government invests in data, but when you ask what it gets back, the answer is usually a case study or two. That makes it very hard to decide where to invest, what to scale and what to stop.

This job changes that. You'll build a clear, trusted view of where data is making a difference across government and where it isn't, so leaders can choose with evidence instead of anecdote.

Why now?

AI is raising the stakes on data, and leaders need to know where their investment will pay off. At the moment there is no single, agreed way to show that across government.

We need one answer to a simple question. What is data worth to citizens, to services, to the economy and to national security? Then we need to use that answer to make better decisions.

It can be done. Others have already published practical guides to valuing data, covering how to take stock of it, assess it and put a value on it. We want to do the same, properly, for government.

Where you'll work

You'll be part of the Government Digital Service (GDS), the digital centre of government. We're home to GOV.UK and the Incubator for AI (i.AI), we lead the Government Digital and Data function, and we have more than 1,000 colleagues across London, Bristol and Manchester.

Job description

What you'll do

Take stock of what government owns. Oversee a joined-up view of public data assets, including inventories, asset intelligence and valuation. Start with the assets that matter most to national infrastructure, public services and citizen-facing products.

Build the yardstick. Set up methods to judge the potential and the realised value of data assets and data-enabled products across their whole life, including where revenue could safely be raised to support public services.

Be the authority on 'value'. Decide what counts as data value, from economic and operational to assurance and risk reduction, and make it consistent and comparable across departments and portfolios. Advise senior leaders on how value is understood, evidenced and explained.

Show where it's working. Use that evidence to see where data creates the most value and where attention or investment should go next.

Help leaders make the call. Give senior decision-makers value-led evidence on priorities, sequencing and investment, so they can see what to scale, redirect, pause or stop. Base it on the whole system, not on one success story.

Keep citizens and users in the room. Make sure their view is built into every prioritisation and investment decision, working closely with Product, Portfolio and Strategy colleagues.

Follow the value through. Build value into decisions before, during and after delivery. Track how it changes over time, from performance and adoption to longer-term outcomes, and feed what you learn back into future choices.

Work safely in sensitive places. Operate within legislative, regulatory, governance and national security frameworks. Make visible the value that

data brings in national security settings, where it often shows up as assurance, resilience or reduced risk.

Tell the story. Turn complex activity across government into clear, credible insight for senior leaders, and help the organisation move from one-off case studies to a system-level view of impact.

Lead a rigorous team. Lead the teams and partners working on data value, insight and asset intelligence, set a high bar for quality and professionalism, and help build a culture where decisions follow evidence.

One boundary. You provide evidence and analysis for commissioning, roadmap and portfolio discussions. You don't own delivery or benefits realisation in departments.

What success looks like

A clear, trusted view of data value across government, built on comparable evidence of use, adoption, outcomes and benefits. Senior leaders can see where data is delivering and where they need to step in.

One system-wide definition of public value from data, covering citizen, service, economic and national outcomes, that shapes priorities, architecture and product decisions.

Valuation methods that let leaders compare data assets and products and decide when to scale, invest, pause or close.

A lifecycle approach, so value shapes decisions before, during and after delivery and feeds the next round of strategy, architecture and product priorities.

A story that senior leaders believe, moving us from one-off case studies to a system-level understanding of impact.

The honest bit

Valuing data across a whole government is hard, and the method is still being built. You'll be setting it up as well as using it, so expect plenty of debate about what counts as value and who decides.

Person specification

This role is for you if...

You've helped very senior people make big decisions using data and evidence, and you can tell the difference between being busy and making a difference. You'll thrive in this role if you have:

Treated data as a strategic asset at a senior level, shaped how it is valued and accessed, and influenced decisions across a portfolio, a system or a whole organisation.

Used evidence to help senior leaders decide. You've brought information together from many sources to guide priorities, sequencing and investment in complicated settings.

Shown sharp analytical judgement. You can tell delivery activity, adoption and real outcomes apart, and you don't mistake progress for impact.

Influenced senior stakeholders by turning complex data, analysis or performance information into clear insight that makes trade-offs and risk-aware decisions easier.

Worked in governed, risk-aware settings, such as legislative, regulatory, assurance or security-sensitive ones, and understand that value can show up as assurance, resilience or reduced risk as well as delivery.

Worked across boundaries and in ambiguity, bringing policy, delivery, technical and operational teams together around one view of performance and value.

Bonus points

You're curious. You've taught yourself something, built something or written about something, at work or in your own time, and you'd enjoy telling us about it.

Benefits

There are many benefits of working at GDS, including:

flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours

a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%

25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days

- an extra day off for the King s birthday
- an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance
- career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development
- a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme
- job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK
- advances on pay, including for travel season tickets
- death in service benefits
- cycle to work scheme and facilities
- access to an employee discounts scheme
- 10 learning days per year
- volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)
- access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

Any move to Government Digital Service from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk

Office attendance

The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.

DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

The standard selection process for roles at GDS consists of:

- a simple application screening process - We only ask for a CV and cover letter of up to 1250 words. Important tip - please ensure that your cover letter includes how you meet the skills and experience listed in the person specification section above

In the Civil Service, we use Success Profiles to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We ll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we ll be assessing you against the following Civil Service Behaviours:

- seeing the bigger picture
- leadership
- working together

Recruitment Timeline

Closing date: 23:55 30th November 2026

Sift completion: 8th December 2026

Global Resourcing Interviews: 10th 18th December 2026

Panel interviews: W/C 25th January 2026

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Sponsorship

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

Security: SC Clearance

Successful candidates must pass a disclosure and barring security check.

Please note that this role requires SC clearance, which would normally need 5 years UK residency in the past 5 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For meaningful checks to be carried out, you will need to have lived in the UK for a sufficient period of time, to enable appropriate checks to be carried out and produce a result which provides the required level of assurance. Whilst a lack of UK residency in itself is not necessarily a bar to a security clearance, and expectation of UK residency may range from 3 to 5 years. Failure to meet the residency requirements needed for the role may result in the withdrawal of provisional jobs offers.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

This role has a minimum assignment duration of 3 years. An assignment duration is the period of time a Senior Civil Servant is expected to remain in the same post to enable them to deliver on the agreed key business outcomes. The assignment duration also supports your career through building your depth of expertise.

As part of accepting this role you will be agreeing to the expected assignment duration set out above. This will not result in a contractual change to your terms and conditions. Please note this is an expectation only, it is not something which is written into your terms and conditions or indeed which the employing organisation or you are bound by. It will depend on your personal circumstances at a particular time and business needs, for example, would not preclude any absence like family friendly leave. It is nonetheless an important expectation, which is why we ask you to confirm you agree to the assignment duration set out above.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland

- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

Working for the Civil Service

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. Read more about prison leaver recruitment (opens in new window).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name :	Tom King
Email :	DSIT-Value@global-resourcing.com
Telephone :	020 8253 1806

Recruitment team

Email :	DSIT-Value@global-resourcing.com

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: info@csc.gov.uk Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.

Follow link to apply

DSIT-Value@global-resourcing.com

Civil Service Commission

disability confident EMPLOYER